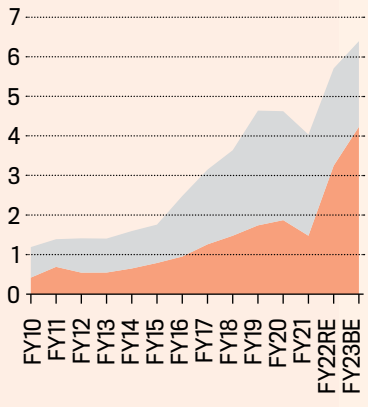


CHANDRADEEP KUMAR

**Both aggregate capex and infrastructure spending rose sharply in FY2021**

**INFRASTRUCTURE MINISTRIES**
(Rs lakh crore)




*Source: Crisil*

**A BIG BUDGETARY PUSH IN FY23 IS FOR THE RAILWAYS WHICH HAS SET A REVENUE TARGET OF Rs 2.39 LAKH CRORE, 18% HIGHER THAN IN 2021-22**

This year, the railways received a budgetary allocation of Rs 140,367 crore, 16.9 per cent higher than the previous year's revised expenditure figures of Rs 120,056 crore. Apart from this, the railways get around Rs 1 lakh crore from extra budgetary support, debt, earnings from PSUs, etc. The public transporter also raises about Rs 10,000 crore internally. The budget has allocated Rs 15,710.44 crore for the Dedicated Freight Corridor (DFC), whose assets will be monetised by the railways for operations and maintenance. But till the time private investment comes in, Vaishnaw is getting PSUs to work and has got funds allocated for them.

Vaishnaw is hopeful that the target of running 400 train sets will be achieved in the next three years. These train sets give a better passenger experience as they provide closed gangways, ensuring a dust-free environment, along with other facilities. Since these trains have faster acceleration and deceleration, the duration of journey and turnaround time are much shorter than conventional trains. The upgrade of signals under the Kavach programme will cover 2,000 km of tracks this year. "The aim is to develop the technology indigenously and make it world class for export," says Vaishnaw. "It should be exported to countries that already use a very good railway network."

## OTHER BIG FOCUS AREAS

To enable faster travel in cities and boost mass transportation services, Sitharaman made a budgetary provision of Rs 19,130 crore for accelerating laying of metro networks. Last year, Rs 18,978 crore were spent on these projects. Along with the Delhi Metro Rail Corporation's (DMRC) metro network in the National Capital Region (NCR), metro trains are operational in Lucknow, Mumbai, Bengaluru, Kochi, Hyderabad and, most recently, Kanpur. In addition to this, the budget made provisions for connecting satellite towns with the big urban centres through the Regional Rapid Transit System (RRTS). The first of its kind network in the NCR region is under construction by the National Capital Region Transport Corporation (NCRTC) and has a capital outlay of Rs 4,710 crore. In the past one year, work has been progressing on the 82-km-long Delhi-Ghaziabad-Meerut RRTS corridor. It will have 25 stations, including two depots and a stabling yard. NCRTC has started construction of 56 km of the corridor.

Airports are one of the pillars of the PM GatiShakti programme. The